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Linux File Server in Windows Domain

Posted by **lanc3** on Jun 28th, 2012 at 5:20 AM

✓ Solved General Linux

Hello,

I am planning to dive in to the linux world and build a linux file server. I have a HP Proliant DL 160 G6 with 3 500 GB Drives. I looking for suggestions on what Linux distro people would recommend, backup software, or anything else I should know before starting this journey. I have almost no experience with linux but I am excited to learn.

Thanks!

Spice (9) Reply (15)

Report

lanc3

THAI PEPPER

Popular Topics in General Linux

user with superuser grants dont let me run commands unless using su...

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✓ Best Answer

Collin8612 Jun 28th, 2012 at 8:07 AM

CAYENNE

The start with CentOS. Don't install a GUI, it can be a crutch. You'll have to do the minimal install. The following list is my biased opinion, but my recommendation would be to do these things in this order:

- Pay close attention the partitioning during installation. Use LVM.

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- Install Samba and SWAT, learn it

- Join your computer to your domain, configure Samba and it the fun begin.

Then, when you've figured out that you didn't like the default configuration AT ALL, go back and reinstall it. By the way, looks like most people are installing the OS to a bootable USB key so that they can dedicate all of the hard drives to storage. You can also just unplug it, replace it with a new key and install a completely new test.

In answer to RoguePacket, FreeNAS has a fantastic user guide: http://www.freenas.org/images/resources/freenas8.0.3/freenas8.0.3_guide.html

View Best Answer in replies below

15 Replies

mbrcomp
JALAPENO

Jun 28th, 2012 at 5:28 AM

Tried several distros, none came close to FREENAS . It is not linux, but freebsd. It is the best (by far) platform for AD-integrated file servers.

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BMoore
DATIL

Jun 28th, 2012 at 5:29 AM

FREENAS is an Operating system you can just install, configure a few options, and its good to go.

Check it out www.freenas.org

Spice (1)

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Collin8612
CAYENNE

Jun 28th, 2012 at 5:45 AM

It's already been recommended - FreeNAS.

I have file servers running Ubuntu and Fedora, and the learning curve is significant but rewarding. They take a beating and are extremely cheap. Using Ubuntu,

Debian, Fedora or CentOS you can install a full file server stack to do all kinds of things, like a SAMBA server with web-based configuration, iSCSI, nfs exports, afs shares, DRBD for remote mirroring, rsync (the best copy program on the planet IMHO), and monitoring clients like munin and nagios.

If you want to install something other than FreeNAS and you plan to use Redhat in the future, use CentOS (stable) or Fedora (cutting edge).

FreeNAS, however, has matured into a robust and full-featured system. Everything and more I mentioned above works on FreeNAS. I don't recommend Openfiler because it's not progressing as a software application. It's major detractors are that the kernel is old, it uses RPath which is not a well-understood underlying OS (for me anyway), and it has a serious problem with its iSCSI implementation.

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RoguePacket
MACE

Jun 28th, 2012 at 7:22 AM

lhietpas wrote:

> ....backup software, or anything else I should know before starting this journey. I have almost no experience with linux....

Michael Lewinger wrote:

> ....It is the best (by far) platform for AD-integrated file servers.

Got FAQ link(s) or guide(s)?

Spice (1)
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OP lanc3 Jun 28th, 2012 at 7:44 AM
THAI PEPPER

I have used freenas before and it is a great product, but I am looking to learn some Linux skills.

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Collin8612 Jun 28th, 2012 at 8:07 AM ✓ Best Answer
CAYENNE

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Spice (4)
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jwsimpson
SERRANO
Jun 28th, 2012 at 9:01 AM

Was in the same boat a few months ago, I had a positive experience with ubuntu. as others have said freenas is a great option too

Report
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Scott Alan Miller
PURE CAPSAICIN
Jun 28th, 2012 at 10:28 AM

lhietpas wrote:

> I have used freenas before and it is a great product, but I am looking to learn some Linux skills.

CentOS is the server stand by for Linux. You really cannot go wrong with it. CentOS is a binary identical copy of RHEL which is THE Linux for business. If you need to learn something... this is what to learn.

If you want some additional flexibility for your fileserver and an OS still common in business, check out OpenSUSE.

Spice (1)
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Scott Alan Miller
PURE CAPSAICIN
Jun 28th, 2012 at 10:29 AM

Collin8612 wrote:

> The start with CentOS. Don't install a GUI, it can be a crutch.

^^ This

Spice (3)
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OP lanc3
THAI PEPPER
Jun 28th, 2012 at 10:42 AM

Thanks for the help everyone. I believe that I am going to go with CentOS and really dive into things and see how it goes.

Spice (1)
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Phil6683
JALAPENO
Jun 28th, 2012 at 10:18 PM

I've played with FreeNAS quite a bit and it has many strengths: but beware: its often very resistant to joining a windows domain properly. If you require this for management or monitoring purposes you may be better off avoiding it. Nexenta does not suffer these issues: but it seems to be moving into a more expensive area.

CentOS is a good place to start: if you do not have experience of linux I would differ from the advice

given out above re: not using a GUI. Trying to do everything from the command line if you are a bit of a newbie can just be too intimidating. Adding a GUI will not take away that much performance: and when you are starting out it can make life quite a bit easier. I would worry about you getting put off by battling the command line. In time, great, get rid of the GUI and go with the terminal: but starting out is hard enough as it is.....

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Mark Carrara
JALAPENO

Jul 3rd, 2012 at 11:08 AM

Once you decided on your distro you asked about backup. If you don't mind digging and I do mean digging Amanda has worked well for me as a backup solution. Not easy to configure, but once you understand how it thinks it will do all kinds of amazing backup stuff.

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PaulHend
SONORA

Aug 4th, 2012 at 6:26 PM

Any Linux distro can be a NAS server. I would recommend a Debian-based distribution such as Ubuntu (because of the community support). The apt-get functionalities are unsurpassed. AS for NAS management, you can install a non-apt-get supported functionality if you want a GUI-based management feature. The GUI is called Webmin and you can ensure that everything is accessible on the fly and troubleshoot any share issue.
http://www.webmin.com/download.html

Report

Was this post helpful?

Scott Alan Miller
PURE CAPSAICIN

Aug 5th, 2012 at 2:18 AM

Somentity wrote:

> Any Linux distro can be a NAS server. I would recommend a Debian-based distribution such as Ubuntu (because of the community support).

It's the community support that makes us normally recommended CentOS. Far larger user base of business users. Smaller overall user base, but I see this as a big positive. When you get community support it is almost exclusively from big business professionals who are working on the assumption that you need business processes. Ubuntu is a great product but its community is mostly hobbyists, gamers and desktop users so their input often assumes that stable, reliable business servers are not your target.

Spice (3)
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Was this post helpful?

OJB
SERRANO
Sep 9th, 2012 at 8:47 AM

Collin8612 wrote:

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All that and learn VIM.

http://www.vim.org/docs.php

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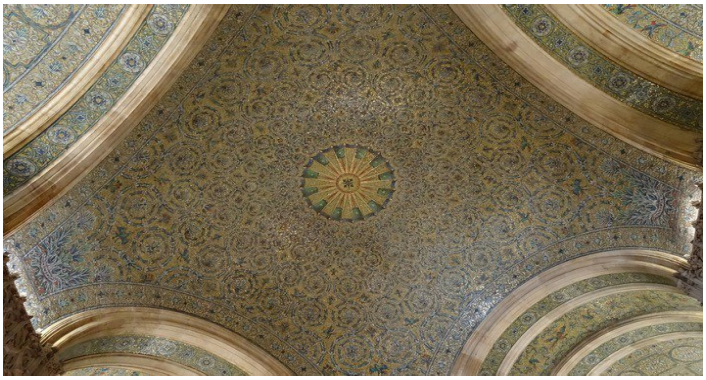

Spark! Pro series – 24th April 2023

Spiceworks Originals

Good morning, Happy Monday. And.. I must apologize for missing Friday's Spark! I was on vacation in California, staying at Camp Pendleton. At about 6am California time shortly before I was about to post, the i...

Ideas for reboot reminder

Software

Hey team, hope all is well with everyone. I got a request from my director to create a MECM application or job/package that targets a daily reboot time of 3AM ET but prompts logged on users to reboot now or postpone. Users may postpone for 1 hour as many ...

Chat GPT generates insecure code

Programming & Development

https://www.theregister.com/2023/04/21/chatgpt_insecure_code/Now I know what you are thinking, so what, you don't actually use it to generate production code. You might use it as a framework, or to get a quick answer, or an idea that you then run with an...

Need screen with plain back

Hardware

Hello, This is an odd one, I need a 27" screen in white, VESA mount with a plain back with a minimal logo as this device will be at a front of house reception area and for the device to fit I need the back to be white and plain...
Any ideas?

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